SDC HACKATHON 2026

Phase 1: Preliminary Project Proposal

Hosted by Xiamen University Malaysia (XMUM) AI Club
Submission Deadline: 25 October 2026

Instructions: Complete every field below and submit as a single PDF document named "SDC2026_TeamName_Preliminary.pdf" before the deadline above. Answers must comply with the word limits stated for each open-ended question. Incomplete submissions may not be eligible for review.

1. Team & Project Overview

Team Name _____

Selected Domain _____

Selected SDG Track (1–17) _____

Project / Solution Name _____

Name (Leader) _____

Email & Phone (Leader) _____

University Affiliation(s) _____

Number of Team Members _____

2. Executive Summary & Problem Statement

2.1 The Problem Context

Describe the specific, real-world challenge your team is tackling. Who is affected by this problem, and why does it matter? Highlight the critical social, environmental, or economic issues involved.

[Maximum 250 words]

2.2 The Proposed AI Solution

Provide a high-level overview of your proposed application. How does it apply artificial intelligence to solve the problem stated above? Briefly mention the tools or technical skills gained from the SDC Phase 1 workshops (e.g., GenAI APIs, database architecture, cloud hosting) that you intend to leverage.

[Maximum 300 words]

3. Technical Architecture & Implementation Plan

3.1 Conceptual Tech Stack

List the technologies, frameworks, APIs, and databases you plan to use to build a functional, deployed prototype. Describe (or attach as an appendix) a simple system block diagram showing how the workshop elements connect into one architecture.

Did your project utilize any official SDC sponsor-provided GenAI API or Cloud Platform? If yes, specify which one and how it is used.

3.2 Design-Thinking & Deployment Strategy

Explain how your team applied design-thinking methodology to ensure this solution is technically viable, user-friendly, and ready for real deployment by Phase 2.

[Maximum 200 words]

4. Preliminary Environmental & SDG Impact Framework

To align with SDC's focus on meaningful global sustainability, establish your project's impact baseline before building the prototype. Use estimated data, published research, or public benchmarks where exact figures are unavailable. Provide the citation of any sources used.

The target, baseline, and KPI you provide here will be used by judges during shortlisting to assess [Innovation and Creativity as well as Feasibility of build]. Vague or unsupported projections may weaken your case for advancing to Phase 2.

Metric Category	**Your Response**
Target SDG Sub-Target(s)	

Metric Category	Your Response
Identify the exact UN SDG sub-target your project addresses *e.g., Target 11.6 "Reduce the adverse per-capita environmental impact of cities, focusing on air quality and waste management."*	
Current Problem Baseline *What is the starting condition of the problem, expressed as a number?* *e.g., "The target infrastructure currently experiences 35% energy inefficiency due to unoptimized scheduling."*	
Core Measurable KPI *The specific unit you will track* *e.g., % reduction in power consumption, processing-latency improvement, or kg of resource waste avoided.*	
Phase 2 Impact Target *Your realistic, percentage-based target by the final prototype presentation* *e.g., "20% improvement in computational resource use."*	

5. Eligibility & Readiness Checklist

Tick all boxes that apply before submitting.

- ☐ All team members have completed the mandatory GenAI, Database, and Cloud Deployment upskilling workshops.

- [ ] The project concept addresses a verified real-world problem mapped directly to one or more UN SDGs.
- [ ] The proposed solution targets a functional, deployed application rather than a theoretical business case study.
- [ ] All fields in this template have been completed within the word limits stated.

6. IP & Originality Declaration

6.1 Pre-Existing / Prior-Owned Work

Does this submission include any code, design, research, or other work that any team member created or owned before the start of this hackathon?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes, briefly describe what was pre-existing and which team member(s) owned it:

6.2 Third-Party Code, Datasets, or Models

Does your project use any third-party code libraries, open-source frameworks, public/private datasets, or pre-trained AI models that your team did not create?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes, list them below (open-source use is permitted provided it is declared and properly licensed/attributed):

Name	Type (code/dataset/model)	License

6.3 Employment-Related IP Conflicts

Is any team member currently bound by an employment, internship, or consulting agreement under which their employer could claim ownership of work they create during this hackathon?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes, please describe the nature of the agreement and which member it concerns:

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7. Declaration

By submitting this proposal, the team leader confirms that the information provided is accurate to the best of the team's knowledge and that the project will be original work created during the SDC 2026 hackathon period.

[Signature]

[Date]